

Getting Started with OpenLDAP

Part 2

Adding Basic Security Measures



Let's get started on adding the initial level of security to OpenLDAP servers.

In the last article, we had set up a basic OpenLDAP server and populated it with data. We had also searched the directories anonymously and seen that we could not add entries (write data to the directory) anonymously. This is because of the default security policy in *slapd.conf*, the LDAP daemon configuration file. In this article, we will take a look at adding an initial level of security to OpenLDAP servers.

The first and the foremost line of defence in any *nix operating system are the file and folder permissions. You must ensure that the server configuration */etc/openldap/slapd.conf* file has 640 permissions and 'root:ldap' are the user and group owners, respectively, as shown below:

```
[vb@vb ~]$ ll /etc/openldap/slapd.conf
-rw-r----- 1 root ldap 2729 Jan 20 11:05 /etc/openldap/slapd.conf
[vb@vb ~]
```

Besides, ideally, the openLDAP rootDN

password must be encrypted rather than remain in plain text. In the last article, we had specified a plain-text password for the rootDN, as is evident from the terminal output below:

```
[root@vb ~]# cat /etc/openldap/slapd.conf | grep rootpw
rootpw    POSTER@rgLinux
[root@vb ~]#
```

As a security measure, this should also be encrypted. To encrypt the root password, we use the *slappasswd* command:

```
[root@vb ~]# slappasswd -s POSTER@rgLinux
(SSHA)gK7EbnY8a0L10R14ZnZQcN338MAZTA4
[root@vb ~]#
```

As can be seen above, SSHA encryption is the default encryption mechanism. You can also change the encryption algorithm to crypt or md5, but SSHA is the preferred scheme.

We can now add this encrypted password